



Shoot At Will

Recurring costs become a non-entity with digital cameras and give you the freedom to shoot as much as you like

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Film is on its way out, worldwide. Although a Rs 1,000 point-and-click film camera may still seem tempting as a temporary solution, there is now no excuse for not getting a digital camera.

Amongst the many things that make digital cameras attractive is the fact that you can experiment with your photographs, taking multiple clicks of the same scene from different angles—and then later see which one turned out best, since you have no film to lose! There is also no wait involved when you want to take a look at your photographs—you can see them instantly, or on your computer monitor. And then there's the question of portability of photographs—how much easier is it to share photos shot with a digital camera than with a film camera?

Picture quality and price used to be the drawbacks to digicams; now, with prices falling and megapixel ratings increasing, these, too, have already begun to vanish.

Digital Camera Trends

It was not too long ago that 2-megapixel cameras were the most happening products on the market; however, within about

two years, seven-megapixel cameras have begun to show up on store shelves.

Rapid developments in sensor technologies have given the necessary shot in the arm, and have brought about a megapixel race amongst manufacturers. "Megapixel" is the magic word: it is used by manufacturers to attract consumers.

The perception amongst consumers is that the higher the megapixel rating of the camera, the better it is. While that is not entirely true, it is true that higher-megapixel cameras are generally better because of the additional features packed into them.

Digital technology is also gaining a good foothold in the professional digital camera category. Professional photographers used to shy away from digital cameras, since according to them, digital cameras lacked the depth in the output that a film camera could produce.

But all this has changed with the introduction of high-end digital cameras with large sensors and featuring some state-of-the-art technologies. The acceptance of digital cameras amongst professionals has increased manifold.

The most prominent feature that dictates the buying of a digital camera is the size of the sensor, given in megapixels. Today a good entry-level digital camera will have at least a 4-megapixel sensor. Slightly higher-end models will sport 6 to 7 megapixels, and will be capable of taking shots at much higher resolutions. This one parameter dictates the momentum of digital camera sales.

A higher-capacity sensor does not necessarily mean a bulky camera. A digital camera small enough to fit into your pocket can employ a 7-megapixel sensor or higher, for example, the

